TRIP PLAN · UPDATED 30 OCT 2026

Vizag · Araku · Vanjangi

5–8 Dec 2026 · 3 friends · ₹8.7–16k per person

FRI 4 DEC	5:00 PM Nampally → Annavaram
SUN 6 DEC	6:30 AM Vizag → Araku
TUE 8 DEC	5:00 PM Vizag → Nampally

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MAP LINKS
Route & places

COSTS
Budget & luggage

CHECKLISTS
Food & pack list

BEFORE YOU GO
Bookings & links

Times, prices and opening hours are estimates. Recheck before travel. Tap any place name to open it in Google Maps.

SAT 5 DEC · DAY 1

Annavaram → Vizag

⛅ **28° / 20°** · Sunny, dry

Typical early December · Daylight 6:18 AM–5:24 PM

⏰ WAKE UP
2:15 AM on the train

💤 SLEEP
9:30 PM

🏨 STAY
Hotel, Dwaraka Nagar

💰 STAY COST
₹2,000–4,000

🍽️ FOOD
₹1,800–3,100

🚕 TRANSPORT
Cab + autos

2:43 AM Map ↗

🚉 Arrive Annavaram

Check live running status; arrival can shift.

GO BY 🚆 Train

Carry – Water & biscuits; nothing is open at night

2:45 AM

🧳 Station & luggage check

Ask about the cloakroom (not confirmed). Backup is a pre-booked lodge or cab.

GO BY 🛺 Auto › 🚕 Cab

Auto – ₹200–400

3:15 AM

🛏️ Rest near Ratnagiri temple

Ask for a lockable room. Rest until about 5:40 AM.

GO BY 🛺 Auto › 🚕 Cab

Room – ₹1,500–3,000

6:00 AM Map ↗

🛕 Ratnagiri temple darshan

Queue times vary.

GO BY 🚶 Walk › 🛺 Auto

🕙 Darshan 6:00 AM–9:00 PM · pause 12:00 PM–12:30 PM

8:00 AM

🍽️ Tiffin near the temple

Arrange through the lodge or check a stall is open.

GO BY 🚶 Walk

Food – ₹300–600

9:00 AM

🚕 Cab to Vizag

About 120 km, 2.5–3 hours.

GO BY 🚕 Pre-booked cab › 🚌 Bus › 🚆 Train

Cab – ₹2,500–4,500

12:15 PM Map ↗

🍛 Lunch in Dwaraka Nagar

Subbayya Gari Hotel for Andhra meals, or Sri Sairam Parlour for veg tiffin.

GO BY 🚶 Walk › 🛺 Auto

Food – ₹600–1,000

1:15 PM

🏨 Check in & freshen up

Normal check-in time, so no early check-in needed. Confirm the booking is for 3.

GO BY 🚶 Walk

2:00 PM Map ↗

🛕 Simhachalam temple

Allow for hill traffic and queues.

GO BY 🚕 Cab › 🛺 Auto › 🚌 Bus

🕙 Darshan 7:00 AM–4:00 PM · 6:00 PM–9:00 PM

Cab/auto – ₹1,000–2,000 return

5:30 PM Map ↗

🏖️ RK Beach & dinner

Until about 8:30 PM. Buy tomorrow's snacks and water tonight; shops won't be open at 4:30 AM.

GO BY 🛺 Auto › 🚕 Cab

🕙 Open all day · Food – ₹900–1,500

To buy – Sunday's train breakfast & Vanjangi snacks

9:00 PM

🎒 Repack for Araku

Move the overnight kit into backpacks and lock the trolleys tonight. See Packing → Backpack vs trolley.

Tips for the day

Short night. Keep the temple transfer flexible and add no stops before the Vizag cab.

Wear temple-appropriate clothes for Annavaram and Simhachalam; footwear is left at the counter.

Go to Simhachalam straight after check-in; queues build up in the evening.

Buy Sunday's snacks and water tonight; shops are shut at 4:30 AM.

SUN 6 DEC · DAY 2

Vizag → Araku valley

⛅ **25° / 12°** · Pleasant, cold night

Typical early December · Desia nights near 10°C

⏰ WAKE UP
4:00 AM

💤 SLEEP
9:00 PM

🏡 STAY
Desia Resorts, Araku

💰 STAY COST
₹2,000–4,500

🍽️ FOOD
₹1,350–2,400

🚙 TRANSPORT
Local vehicle

4:30 AM

🍳 Quick breakfast, then VSKP

Eat what you bought last night if the hotel kitchen isn't open. Overnight packs only.

GO BY 🛺 Auto › 🚕 Cab

Auto/cab – ₹250–500

Carry – Train breakfast, 2 L water each, Vanjangi snacks

5:45 AM Map ↗

🧳 Bags into VSKP cloakroom

Platform 1. Bags locked, ticket + ID, keep the receipt. Confirm you can collect around 8:30 PM Monday.

GO BY 🚶 Walk

Cloakroom – ~₹10–15 per bag

6:30 AM

🚆 Train to Araku

About 131 km, arrives around 10:30 AM.

GO BY 🚆 Train

Carry – Food; don't count on a pantry

10:45 AM Map ↗

🏛️ Tribal Museum

About 45 minutes.

GO BY 🚙 Local vehicle › 🛺 Auto

🕙 About 10:00 AM–5:00 PM · may pause 1:00 PM–2:00 PM

Entry – ₹40 each

Vehicle – ₹2,000–3,500 for the afternoon

11:30 AM Map ↗

☕ Coffee Museum & chocolate factory

Across the road. Coffee tasting and coffee chocolates.

GO BY 🚶 Walk

🕙 About 10:00 AM–5:00 PM

12:30 PM

🍛 Lunch at Araku Coffee House

Beside the museums.

GO BY 🚶 Walk

Food – ₹750–1,200

1:30 PM Skip if late Map ↗

🌳 Padmapuram Gardens

About an hour. Tree-top huts and toy train.

GO BY 🚙 Local vehicle › 🛺 Auto

🕙 About 9:00 AM–5:00 PM

2:40 PM Skip if late Map ↗

⛪ Christ the King Church

Araku Mission church in town. Sunday services may be on, so keep it quiet and short.

GO BY 🚙 Local vehicle › 🛺 Auto

3:15 PM

🛒 Stock up in Araku town

Last proper shops before tomorrow.

GO BY 🚶 Walk

To buy – water, biscuits, fruit, chikki, tea in a flask

3:30 PM Map ↗

🏡 Check in at Desia Resorts

About 13 km out on the Chaparai road, 20–30 minutes. Drop packs and head out.

GO BY 🚙 Local vehicle › 🛺 Auto

4:00 PM Skip if late Map ↗

💧 Chaparai water cascade

Close to the resort. Slippery rocks. Leave by 5:00 PM.

GO BY 🚙 Local vehicle › 🛺 Auto

🕙 Daylight, about 6:00 AM–6:00 PM

Entry – free

Carry – Water; stalls are few

6:30 PM

😴 Early dinner, early sleep

Confirm the 3:15 AM pickup, a packed breakfast or tea, and late check-out. Sleep by 9:00 PM.

Food – ₹600–1,200

Tips for the day

Before the train arrives, agree the afternoon route and the Monday 3:15 AM pickup with one driver.

Araku nights are cold in December. Keep a warm layer in your backpack, not the trolley.

Phone signal is patchy around Desia and Vanjangi. Download offline Google Maps for the Araku area.

Keep Araku coffee and chocolates in a ziplock in your backpack until Monday night.

MON 7 DEC · DAY 3

Vanjangi → Borra → Vizag

🌫️ **24° / 8°** · Misty dawn, mild day

Typical early December · Vanjangi dawn 5–10°C

⏰ WAKE UP
3:00 AM

💤 SLEEP
10:30 PM

🏨 STAY
Hotel, Dwaraka Nagar

💰 STAY COST
₹2,000–4,000

🍽️ FOOD
₹1,950–3,250

🚙 TRANSPORT
One cab, ₹6–9k

3:15 AM Map ↗

🚙 Leave Desia for Vanjangi

35–40 km on hill roads, 1–1.5 hours, then a 20–30 minute walk up. Headlamps and warm layers. Stay together.

GO BY 🚙 Pre-booked cab or jeep

Carry – Water, snacks, tea flask; stalls at the top may be shut

6:15 AM

🌄 Sunrise over the clouds

The cloud sea is the view even if the sun hides. Head down by 7:30 AM.

GO BY 🥾 Trek

9:00 AM

🍳 Breakfast & check out at Desia

Freshen up and leave by 9:45 AM.

GO BY 🚙 Same cab

Food – ₹450–750

10:30 AM Skip if late Map ↗

🌲 Araku Pinery

Pine plantation at Anjoda, about 8 km past Araku on the Vizag road. 30–40 minutes.

GO BY 🚙 Same cab

🕙 6:00 AM–6:00 PM

Carry – Car snacks; few stalls until Borra

11:15 AM Map ↗

🌉 Wooden bridge, Sunkarametta

Walkway through coffee plantations, about 14 km from Araku. About 45 minutes.

GO BY 🚙 Same cab › 🚶 Walk

🕙 8:00 AM–5:00 PM

12:00 PM Skip if late Map ↗

⛪ CBM Church, Sunkarimetta

Short stop near the wooden bridge, about 20 minutes.

GO BY 🚙 Same cab

12:45 PM

🍗 Lunch near Borra

Stalls here are known for bamboo chicken. Veg meals too.

GO BY 🚙 Same cab

Food – ₹600–1,000

1:30 PM Map ↗

🪨 Borra Caves

Open about 10:00 AM–5:00 PM. Allow 1.5 hours; lots of steps.

GO BY 🚙 Same cab › 🚶 Walk

🕙 10:00 AM–5:00 PM · last entry 4:30 PM

Entry – ₹60 each

Phone camera – ₹25

3:00 PM Skip if late Map ↗

💦 Katiki waterfalls

About 7 km by local jeep, then a 20–30 minute uphill trek. 2–2.5 hours in all. Skip if you leave Borra after 3:30 PM.

GO BY 🛻 Local jeep › 🥾 Trek

🕙 Jeeps from about 8:00 AM · daylight only

Jeep – ask at Borra

Carry – Water & snacks; nothing on the trail

5:30 PM

🚕 Drive to Vizag

About 88 km of ghat road, 2.5–3 hours.

GO BY 🚙 Same cab

Carry – Snacks in case of delays

8:30 PM Map ↗

🧳 Bags from VSKP, check in, dinner

Show the cloakroom receipt, then the hotel around Dwaraka Nagar.

GO BY 🚙 Same cab › 🛺 Auto

Food – ₹900–1,500

Tips for the day

Longest day, 3:15 AM to about 9:00 PM. If everyone is tired after Borra, drop Katiki and reach Vizag by about 7:00 PM.

Borra Caves are damp and slippery inside. Wear shoes with grip.

Try to finish the ghat road before it gets fully dark.

Keep the cloakroom receipt handy for the 8:30 PM bag pickup.

TUE 8 DEC · DAY 4

Vizag sights → home

☀ **27° / 20°** · Sunny, humid

Typical early December · Little shade at noon

⏰ WAKE UP
6:30 AM

💤 SLEEP
On the train

🚆 STAY
Overnight train

🚉 TRAIN HOME
5:00 PM

🍽 FOOD
₹1,350–2,250

🚕 TRANSPORT
Day cab, ₹2–3k

6:30 AM

🔒 Pack & lock every bag

The cloakroom only takes locked bags. Keep a day bag with water, ID, tickets and valuables.

7:15 AM

🍳 Breakfast & check out

Out by 7:45 AM.

Food – ₹450–750

8:00 AM Map ↗

🧳 Bags into VSKP cloakroom

Show today's ticket + ID, keep the receipt, carry cash for the fee.

GO BY 🛺 Auto › 🚕 Cab

Cloakroom – ~₹10–15 per bag

8:45 AM Skip if late Map ↗

🏖 Rushikonda Beach

About 12 km north. Calm in the morning.

GO BY 🚕 Day cab (8 h / 80 km) › 🛺 Auto › 🚌 Bus

🕙 Open all day

10:00 AM Map ↗

🚡 Kailasagiri hill park

Park opens about 9:00 AM, ropeway about 11:00 AM. Check today's timings.

GO BY 🚕 Day cab › 🛺 Auto

🕙 Park 9:00 AM–6:30 PM · ropeway 11:00 AM–8:00 PM

Entry – ₹5–10

Ropeway – ~₹150

11:30 AM Skip if late Map ↗

🌊 Tenneti Park & beach

On the beach road, 20–30 minutes.

GO BY 🚕 Day cab › 🛺 Auto

12:15 PM

🍛 Lunch near RK Beach road

Close to the museums.

GO BY 🚕 Day cab › 🚶 Walk

Food – ₹900–1,500

1:15 PM Skip if late Map ↗

🎖 Victory at Sea memorial

Open-air, on the beach road, with a short RK Beach walk.

GO BY 🚶 Walk

🕙 Open all day

2:00 PM Map ↗

🚢 Submarine & TU-142 museums

Opposite each other. Recheck hours. Leave by 3:45 PM.

GO BY 🚶 Walk

🕙 2:00 PM–8:30 PM · Kursura closed Mondays

Entry – ~₹330 for 3

3:45 PM

🥡 Buy dinner for the train

Near the beach road or at the station.

GO BY 🚶 Walk

Carry – Dinner & water; pantry food is unreliable

4:00 PM Map ↗

🧳 Collect bags at VSKP

About 5 km, 15–20 minutes. Show the receipt.

GO BY 🚕 Day cab › 🛺 Auto

5:00 PM

🚆 Train to Nampally

About 709 km, overnight.

GO BY 🚆 Train

Tips for the day

Running late? Drop Tenneti Park or the memorial first. Be at the cloakroom by 4:00 PM.

The beach road has little shade at midday. Carry sunscreen, caps and water.

Kailasagiri is windy at the top; hold on to caps on the ropeway.

Check the platform number on the station display when you collect the bags.

Route & places

Stops in order

🛕 **Annavaram**
Sat 2:43 AM arrival · temple
↓ 120 km by cab

🌆 **Vizag**
Sat · Simhachalam, RK Beach
↓ 131 km by train

⛰️ **Araku**
Sun · museums, gardens, church
↓ 13 km

🏡 **Desia Resorts**
Sun night · Chaparai cascade
↓ 35–40 km

🌄 **Vanjangi**
Mon · sunrise
↓ 85–90 km via Araku, Pinery, Sunkarametta

🪨 **Borra Caves**
Mon · Katiki optional
↓ 88 km

🌆 **Vizag**
Mon night · Tue sights
↓ 709 km by train

🏠 **Nampally**
Tue 5:00 PM departure

Places on the map

SAT 5 DEC

🚉 Arrive Annavaram ↗
🛕 Ratnagiri temple darshan ↗
🍛 Lunch in Dwaraka Nagar ↗
🛕 Simhachalam temple ↗
🏖️ RK Beach & dinner ↗

SUN 6 DEC

🧳 Bags into VSKP cloakroom ↗
🏛️ Tribal Museum ↗
☕ Coffee Museum & chocolate factory ↗
🌳 Padmapuram Gardens ↗
⛪ Christ the King Church ↗
🏡 Check in at Desia Resorts ↗
💧 Chaparai water cascade ↗

MON 7 DEC

🚙 Leave Desia for Vanjangi ↗
🌲 Araku Pinery ↗
🌉 Wooden bridge, Sunkarametta ↗
⛪ CBM Church, Sunkarimetta ↗
🪨 Borra Caves ↗
💦 Katiki waterfalls ↗

TUE 8 DEC

🏖️ Rushikonda Beach ↗
🚡 Kailasagiri hill park ↗
🌊 Tenneti Park & beach ↗
🎖️ Victory at Sea memorial ↗
🚢 Submarine & TU-142 museums ↗

Budget

For 3, excluding train fares. Stays, food and entries come to about ₹15,000–29,000; transport is on top. Monday's full-day cab (₹6,000–9,000) puts you in the upper half.

MOST PRACTICAL

Autos + cabs	**₹8,700–16,000 pp**
Road transport	₹11,000–19,000
Whole trip	₹26,000–48,000

MOST CONVENIENT

Private cab	**₹10,000–18,700 pp**
Road transport	₹15,000–27,000
Whole trip	₹30,000–56,000

LOWEST COST

Bus + auto	**₹7,800–15,200 pp**
Road transport	₹8,500–16,500
Whole trip	₹23,500–45,500

Monday's Borra route has no practical bus, so this mostly applies to the Vizag days.

LIMITED USE

Own car, Vizag days only	**₹7,800–15,300 pp**
Road transport	₹700–1,200 fuel + parking
Whole trip	₹23,500–46,000

Only if the car is already in Vizag. Hill legs still need cabs.

Luggage

Luggage plan

🛕 **Annavaram, Sat**
Cloakroom unconfirmed; use a lockable lodge room

🚉 **VSKP, Sun 5:45 AM → Mon ~8:30 PM**
Big bags in the cloakroom; only overnight packs go to Araku

🚉 **VSKP, Tue 8:00 AM → 4:00 PM**
Bags in the cloakroom, not with the hotel

📋 **Cloakroom rules**
Bags locked, ticket + ID, keep the receipt, cash for fees

Backpack vs trolley

🎒 Each backpack

Carry these all the time, Sat to Tue

🪪 **Documents & money**
ID, tickets on phone, wallet, cards, cash

📱 **Phone kit**
Phone, charger, cable, power bank, earphones

💧 **Water & snacks**
2 L water, biscuits, nuts, chikki

🔦 **Headlamp or torch**
For the 03:15 Vanjangi start

🧥 **Warm layer & rain**
Fleece or jacket, cap, light rain jacket

👕 **Sun night clothes**
One change, sleepwear, innerwear, socks

🪥 **Mini toiletries**
Toothbrush, paste, sunscreen, lip balm, wipes, sanitiser

💊 **Medicines**
Personal medicines and a few band-aids

👓 **Eyewear**
Spectacles or sunglasses, with case

🩴 **Small towel & slippers**
For Chaparai, Katiki and the resort

🤝 Shared

One each, so the weight is spread

📷 **Camera bag**
Camera, spare battery, memory cards

📐 **Tripod**
Strap it to the outside of a backpack

☕ **Tea flask**
Filled at Desia for the sunrise

🩹 **First-aid pouch**
Pain relief, ORS, antiseptic, motion-sickness tablets

🛍️ **Ziplock & carry bags**
Wet clothes, snacks, Araku coffee and chocolates

🧳 Trolley bags

In the VSKP cloakroom Sun 5:45 AM → Mon 8:30 PM and Tue 8:00 AM → 4:00 PM

👔 **Clothes for Mon night & Tue**
Plus any extra shoes

🧴 **Full-size toiletries**
Everything beyond the mini kit

🙏 **Temple clothes**
After Saturday's darshan

🧺 **Laundry bag**
Used clothes from Saturday

🔌 **Spare chargers & adapters**
Anything not needed in the hills

🔒 **Lock & label**
Lock every trolley; tag with name and phone number

⚠️ Never in the trolleys: cash, cards, ID, phones, cameras, power banks or medicines. The cloakroom only covers bags up to a small value.

Food & pack list

Food to carry

SAT 2:43 AM
Water and biscuits for the night arrival at Annavaram

SAT night
Sunday's train breakfast and Vanjangi snacks, bought in Vizag

SUN 3:15 PM
Top up in Araku town: water, biscuits, fruit, chikki, tea flask

SUN 4:00 PM
Water for Chaparai; few stalls

MON 3:15 AM
Vanjangi: water, snacks, hot tea. Ask Desia for a packed breakfast

MON 10:30 AM
Car snacks for the Pinery, bridge and CBM Church

MON 3:00 PM
Katiki: water and snacks; nothing on the trail

TUE 3:45 PM
Dinner and water for the overnight train

Pack list

Documents & money

- ☐ ID cards (names match tickets)
- ☐ Train tickets (phone + screenshot)
- ☐ Wallet
- ☐ Credit / debit cards
- ☐ Cash in small notes
- ☐ Hotel & Desia booking details

Electronics

- ☐ Phone chargers
- ☐ Power banks (charged)
- ☐ Spare cables & adapter
- ☐ Camera, battery & memory card
- ☐ Tripod
- ☐ Headlamp / torch

Food & water

- ☐ Water bottles (2 L each)
- ☐ Dry snacks: biscuits, nuts, chikki
- ☐ Small flask for tea

Clothing

- ☐ Warm layers, jacket & cap
- ☐ Walking shoes with grip
- ☐ Slippers / sandals
- ☐ Light rain jacket or umbrella
- ☐ Temple-appropriate clothes
- ☐ Small towel & spare clothes

Personal & health

- ☐ Spectacles / sunglasses
- ☐ Personal medicines
- ☐ Band-aids & pain relief
- ☐ Sunscreen & lip balm
- ☐ Toothbrush & toiletries
- ☐ Tissues, wet wipes, sanitiser

Bags

- ☐ Small locks for every bag
- ☐ Day backpack
- ☐ Ziplock bags for wet items

Before you go

Book ahead

☐ 🚕 **Cab, Annavaram → Vizag**
Sat 9:00 AM pickup near the temple

☐ 🏡 **Desia Resorts**
Sun night · ask for late check-out on Mon

☐ 🚙 **Araku local vehicle**
Sun 10:30 AM–5:00 PM · museums, gardens, church, Desia, Chaparai

☐ 🚙 **Monday full-day cab**
3:15 AM Desia → Vanjangi → Desia → Pinery → Sunkarametta → Borra → Vizag

☐ 🚕 **Vizag day cab**
Tue 8:00 AM–4:30 PM · 8 h / 80 km package

☐ 📝 **Written quotes from drivers**
Waiting time, night pickup, hill roads

Recheck

🚉 **Annavaram arrival**
2:43 AM on the ticket; check live status

🚆 **Araku train**
6:30 AM from VSKP on Sunday

🧳 **VSKP cloakroom**
Hours, fees, Monday ~8:30 PM collection

🚙 **Desia → Vanjangi**
Drive time with the resort or driver

🕗 **Opening hours**
Borra, Chaparai, Kailasagiri, museums

🛻 **Katiki jeep**
Availability at Borra on Monday

Useful links

🛕 Annavaram Devasthanam ↗

🚆 Trains Vizag → Araku ↗

🌄 Vanjangi info ↗

🪨 Borra Caves timings ↗

💦 Katiki waterfalls guide ↗

🚡 Kailasagiri timings ↗